FIGHTERBASE

Kosher

Diet guide

Jewish dietary law. No pork or shellfish; meat and dairy kept apart.



Prepared 11 October 2026 for FighterBase members. Eating styles library, one of a set.

> DRAFT: not yet reviewed by a registered dietitian. General information only, not medical advice. Check with your doctor or a registered dietitian before changing how you eat, especially if you have a medical condition, are pregnant, or are under 18.

USING FIGHTERBASE

How to use this diet guide

This diet guide is part of your eating styles library in the FighterBase app. The pages that follow are built to be skimmed. You do not need to read it all at once.

1. **Open Nutrition**
   In the app, open the **Nutrition** tab and tap **Eating styles**.

2. **Tap Kosher**
   Read the short summary, what to eat, what to go easy on, and what to watch.

3. **Follow it**
   Tap **Follow this style**. Recipes and the Foods list then filter to match, so you only see what fits. You can follow more than one style.

4. **Download the PDFs**
   Use **Full food list** and **Diet guide** to save these to your phone. Handy for the shop or a restaurant.

5. **Log it and train**
   Meals you log count towards your day. Spend your energy on training, not on reading labels.

> Looking for the full list of foods? Download the **Full food list** PDF from the same screen. It names every allowed and avoided food.

THE BASICS

What is Kosher?

Food that meets Jewish dietary law (kashrut). No pork or shellfish, meat from kosher sources, and meat and dairy not eaten together.

Where it comes from

Kosher (kashrut) comes from Jewish law. Permitted animals, how they are slaughtered, and the separation of meat and dairy are the core rules. Communities differ in how strictly they keep these rules and which certifications they trust.

The main ideas

1. Permitted land animals have split hooves and chew the cud (beef, lamb, goat, deer). Pork and rabbit are not kosher.
2. Permitted fish have fins and scales. Shellfish and other seafood without fins and scales are not kosher.
3. Meat and poultry must be slaughtered by a trained person and prepared in the prescribed way.
4. Meat and dairy are not eaten together, and separate utensils are used. Waiting times between meat and dairy vary by community.
5. Foods are classed as meat (fleishig), dairy (milchig) or neutral (pareve, such as fish, eggs, vegetables).
6. Passover has additional rules about leavened foods.

Who it suits

- Jewish people who keep kosher
- People cooking for or eating with kosher-observant friends

> **Talk to your doctor or a registered dietitian first if:**
>
> - You have a medical condition and are fasting (for example Yom Kippur)
> - You are pregnant, breastfeeding or under 18 and fasting

TRAINING

Fuel for training

- Sports nutrition itself does not change. Protein, carbs and fluids still apply.
- If you eat meat at one meal, plan dairy-free recovery snacks until your waiting time has passed, or use pareve options.
- Pareve protein sources (fish, eggs, legumes, tofu) are flexible around meat and dairy meals.
- Fasts: talk to a rabbi and a doctor about training and hydration.

> Parve foods (eggs, fish, grains, veg) fit before or after any meal. Plan recovery shakes around meat meals if they're dairy-based.

Nutrients to keep an eye on

Protein
repair
Where: kosher meat, fish, eggs, tofu, legumes

Calcium
bones
Where: dairy meals, sardines, fortified alternatives

Iron
oxygen carrying
Where: kosher red meat, lentils, spinach

Vitamin D
bones
Where: oily fish, eggs, sunlight, supplement

Common mistakes

- Mixing meat and dairy by mistake (for example butter on a meat meal)
- Assuming vegetarian equals kosher: wine, grape products and some cheeses need certification
- Forgetting gelatine in sweets and supplements
- Ignoring cross-contamination in restaurants

EVERYDAY LIFE

Labels, eating out and swaps

Reading labels

- Look for a recognised kosher mark (hechsher) and whether it says meat, dairy or pareve
- Gelatine and rennet: usually not kosher unless certified
- Grape products (wine, grape juice, some vinegars) need certification
- Insects in leafy vegetables: check carefully

Eating out

- Eat at kosher-certified restaurants where possible.
- Otherwise choose fish or vegetarian dishes with a rabbi's guidance on what is acceptable.
- Check cheese, wine and desserts.
- Ask about separate cooking surfaces.

Easy swaps

Pork sausage	→	Kosher beef or chicken sausage
Cheese on a burger	→	Pareve alternative or leave it out
Gelatine sweets	→	Certified kosher sweets or pectin-based
Butter at a meat meal	→	Olive oil or pareve margarine

PUT IT INTO PRACTICE

A sample week

One way a week could look. Portions and total food depend on you and your training.

	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner
Mon	Eggs, toast, fruit	Tuna sandwich, salad	Roast chicken, potatoes, vegetables
Tue	Porridge, fruit	Hummus and falafel pitta	Beef stew, rice
Wed	Yoghurt, granola (dairy meal)	Vegetable soup, bread	Salmon, rice, greens
Thu	Omelette (pareve)	Chicken salad wrap	Beef burgers (no cheese), salad
Fri	Cereal and milk (dairy meal)	Lentil soup, bread	Grilled chicken, sweet potato
Sat	Pancakes, fruit	Leftover chicken	Fish with roast vegetables
Sun	Eggs, avocado toast	Cold cuts, salad	Slow-cooked beef, vegetables

Snacks

Fruit · Nuts · Hummus and vegetables · Boiled eggs · Rice cakes · Kosher-certified protein bars (check meat or dairy)

Shopping list

Kosher-certified meat and poultry · Fish with fins and scales · Eggs, vegetables, fruit · Kosher cheese and dairy · Certified wine and grape products · Pareve margarine and desserts

GOOD TO KNOW

Questions people ask

What is pareve?

Food that is neither meat nor dairy, such as fish, eggs, vegetables and fruit.

How long between meat and dairy?

It depends on community custom, from a few hours up to six. Ask your rabbi.

Is a vegetarian diet kosher?

Not automatically. Wine, grape products, cheese and some additives need certification.

Further reading

Your rabbi or kashrut authority; recognised kosher certifiers in your country.

For fighters and combat athletes

- **No eating style makes a rapid weight cut safe.** Sweating, fluid restriction and crash diets hurt performance and can be dangerous. Plan any weight cut with a registered sports dietitian and your coach, well before the weigh-in.
- **Fuel the training first.** Hard sparring and conditioning need carbohydrate and enough total food. If a style cuts a food group, have a plan to replace what is lost.
- **Protein across the day.** A common general range for people training hard is about 1.4 to 2.0 g per kg of body weight a day (draft range, to be confirmed by a dietitian).
- **Try changes in training, never in fight week.** Test new foods, supplements and timing well before competition.
- **Under 18, pregnant, or with a medical condition:** get advice from a doctor or dietitian before changing your diet.

FIGHTERBASE

Train. Eat. Recover. Repeat.

Your eating styles library lives in the Nutrition tab. Pick a style, follow it, and get back to training.

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